

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 128

By Howell

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Lois Johnson Bates of Benton.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Lois Johnson Bates; and

WHEREAS, Lois Bates was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Lois Bates was born on February 7, 1925, in Varnell, Georgia, to John H. and Edna Johnson; she grew up in Conasauga, Tennessee, and graduated from Polk County High School in 1943; and

WHEREAS, after high school, Ms. Bates began working in Oak Ridge at Carbide and Carbon Chemical Corporation until World War II ended in 1947; in 1962, she graduated from nursing school conducted by Bradley County Board of Education and the Tennessee State of Vocational Board of Education; and

WHEREAS, for approximately forty years, Lois Bates served with the utmost acumen and alacrity as a nurse at Bradley Memorial Hospital, Cleveland Community Hospital, and Benton Family Healthcare Center, devoting herself fully to caring for each and every patient; and

WHEREAS, a dedicated volunteer, Ms. Bates was called to help underserved communities, and she was proud to work with The Empty Stocking Fund, an organization founded to serve underprivileged children, for over thirty years; she also volunteered with the Meals on Wheels Program; and

WHEREAS, Lois Bates was a devoted wife, mother, and grandmother, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, she is survived by her children, Dennis Bates and Vicki (David) Burris; grandchildren, Amanda Burris and Justin (Kara) Burris; and great-granddaughters, Kimber Burris, Carsen Burris, and Camryn Burris; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Bates is further survived by her sister, Sue Self, and several nieces, nephews, and a host of friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, Lois Bates was preceded in death by her husband of sixty-nine years, J.P. Bates; her siblings, Raymond Johnson, Annie Hullender, Johnnie Fisher, Dimple Brock, Lilly Gurley, William "Buck" Johnson, Gene Johnson, Bid Self, and Margie Johnson; and

WHEREAS, Lois Bates leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Lois Johnson Bates, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Ms. Bates.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.